

THE 7 POWER MOVES — BRIAN EDITION —

Your Authentic UX Design Narrative

POWER MOVE 01 ORIGIN STORY MASTERY

RAW STORY

You took the road less traveled — retail work, real-world pressure, and a late pivot into UX — not despite your unconventional path, but because of it. While others were studying users in textbooks, you were on the floor watching them struggle, get confused, and give up. You enrolled in an accelerated bachelor's program while working demanding hours, driven by a conviction that design should actually work for people who are routinely forgotten. Your empathy isn't a soft skill. It's a survival skill you earned.

REFINED POWER LINE

I didn't come up through a design school — I came up through the school of watching real people get failed by systems that weren't built for them. That's not a gap in my resume. That's my competitive edge.

🔗 **DEPLOY WHEN:** Interviews, networking openers, LinkedIn 'About' section, and any time someone asks 'so how did you get into UX?'

POWER MOVE 02 VICTORY SHOWCASE

RAW STORY

Your most powerful project work centers on designing for users who are underserved, underconfident, or overlooked — people who never expect a product to be made for them. You've applied structured UX methodology (research, synthesis, iteration) while bringing the rare ability to actually feel the frustration your users feel, not just document it. The result: designs that don't just pass a usability test — they make someone feel like they matter.

REFINED POWER LINE

I don't just solve usability problems — I design for the user who already expects to fail. When they don't, that's the win.

SUPPORTING PROOF POINTS

- Applied full UX research and iteration process in an accelerated academic environment under real professional pressure
- Brings lived retail experience as a primary research lens — has personally observed the pain points users won't say out loud
- Designs with a clear equity lens: who is being excluded, and how does this fix it?

 **DEPLOY WHEN:** Portfolio walk-throughs, 'tell me about a project' questions, and case study presentations

POWER MOVE 03 SECRET WEAPON INVENTORY

RAW INSIGHT

Your secret weapon is empathy that's operationalized — not just 'I care about users,' but a trained instinct to ask questions before jumping to answers, to slow down where others rush, and to surface what users feel but don't say. You ask questions the way a good designer does it: not to gather information, but to help people understand themselves. That's a rare and powerful research superpower.

REFINED POWER LINE

My superpower is turning empathy into insight — I don't just listen to what users say, I notice what they're embarrassed to admit. That's where the real design problems live.

EVIDENCE THIS IS REAL

- Natural Socratic questioning style — leads others to discover insights rather than delivering conclusions
- Retail background trained you to read non-verbal cues, hesitation, and discomfort in real-time
- Personal history of being the overlooked user makes you deeply attuned to who isn't at the design table

 **DEPLOY WHEN:** User research discussions, team interviews, 'what's your design process?' questions, and research-focused roles

POWER MOVE 04 VOICE AMPLIFICATION

RAW INSIGHT

You show up in collaboration not as the loudest voice, but as the most clarifying one. You pull threads, ask the question nobody asked, and help teams get to better decisions by making the thinking visible. You're not a wallflower and you're not a bulldozer — you're the designer who creates the space for the right answer to emerge.

REFINED POWER LINE

I don't just contribute to design conversations — I change their direction. I ask the question that reframes the room.

🔗 **DEPLOY WHEN:** Team collaboration scenarios, 'how do you work with stakeholders?' questions, cross-functional project discussions

POWER MOVE 05 TERRITORY CLAIMING

RAW INSIGHT

You want to design products that make overlooked people feel seen — not as a niche specialty, but as a standard. You believe design has a responsibility to the people it excludes, and you're building a career to hold that line. This isn't a cause you adopted. It's the mission that made you choose design in the first place.

REFINED POWER LINE

My mission is to raise the floor of who gets good design — not just build experiences for the already-confident, but for everyone who's been quietly written off by products that weren't made with them in mind.

🔗 **DEPLOY WHEN:** 'Where do you see yourself in 5 years?', values-fit conversations, company culture interviews, and cover letters

POWER MOVE 06 TRUTH DECLARATION

RAW INSIGHT

Your contrarian UX belief: most design fails because it's built for the idealized user — confident, tech-savvy, with time to explore. The real user is tired, distracted, slightly confused, and just needs it to work. Designing for that person, not the idealized one, is the real discipline. And most teams skip it.

REFINED POWER LINE

The biggest mistake in UX is designing for the user you wish you had. I design for the user you actually have — the one who's struggling and doesn't have time to figure out your product.

🔗 **DEPLOY WHEN:** Thought leadership moments, portfolio presentations, interviews with research or strategy components, LinkedIn posts

POWER MOVE 07 BARRIER CONFRONTATION

RAW TRUTH

The barrier has been the same one that holds back a lot of talented people who came up outside the 'expected' path: the voice that says your experience doesn't count because it doesn't look like everyone else's. The non-traditional background, the retail years, the accelerated program — all of it has been fuel, but you haven't always been willing to say that out loud as a strength. That changes now.

REFINED POWER LINE

I used to translate my background into something that sounded more 'acceptable.' I'm done translating. My path is the differentiator — and I'm ready to own it completely.

 **DEPLOY WHEN:** Before any high-stakes application or interview. Post it somewhere visible. This is the internal reset.

TL;DR — BRAND STRATEGY

Brian is the UX designer who makes overlooked users feel like the product was finally built for them — because he's been that user, and he never forgot it.